Cameron), which offered Britain provisions on its relationship with the euro, limited social benefits for EU migrants, and an "emergency brake" on in-work benefits.[22] These efforts reflected the EU's willingness to address British concerns while maintaining the broader framework of European integration.

Parallel to these negotiations, the EU launched a robust public relations campaign aimed at both internal and external audiences. Institutions like the European Commission and the European Council provided regular updates on Brexit negotiations, emphasizing the EU's commitment to preserving its single market and unity. High-profile leaders such as Jean-Claude Juncker, Donald Tusk, and Michel Barnier took center stage in press conferences and speeches, articulating the EU's positions.[23] This communication strategy extended to social media and dedicated online platforms designed to educate the public about Brexit's implications (Brändle, Galpin, and Trenz 2022). Such efforts sought to stem any contagion effect from Brexit by reinforcing confidence in the EU among its remaining member states and beyond.

However, not all negotiations unfolded in the public eye. Many aspects of the Brexit process were deliberately kept behind closed doors to allow for candid discussions and compromise on contentious issues. Confidential negotiations enabled both UK and EU leaders to explore politically sensitive solutions without immediate public scrutiny, fostering an environment in which agreements could be reached on polarizing matters (Barnier 2021). Moreover, where the UK was able to extract concessions from the EU, secrecy prevented other countries from observing any potential benefits for them from an exit.

Despite these efforts, the UK officially left the EU in 2020, marking the first instance of a member state exiting the bloc. In the wake of Brexit, the EU adapted its strategies to sideline the UK while reinforcing its own cohesion. During leave negotiations, the EU maintained unity among its member states, isolating the UK diplomatically (Schuette 2023). After Britain's departure, the EU moved forward with a range of policies that reflected the new dynamics of the bloc. For instance, it adjusted its 2021–2027 Multiannual Financial Framework to redistribute budgetary commitments among member states and established a €5 billion Brexit Adjustment Reserve to support industries and regions most affected by the